

Delaware County Drainage Board Meeting August 12th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WiBqA45Gmf8
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board: Drainage Board

Meeting Date: August 12

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the August 12 Drainage Board meeting to order at [00:07:03](#), followed by the Pledge of Allegiance and a roll call.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Whitehead, Mr. Hamilton, Commissioner, Mr. Christie, Mr. Bustel, Mr. Rood (noted as Mr. Root/Rood in roll calls), and Mr. Borchert.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted as absent during roll call.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Noted as the board chair/mayor directing proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:07:05](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the July 8 meeting were approved by roll call vote ([00:07:49](#)).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:07:56 Tabled Business: A. McConnell Reconstruction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Hamilton / Mr. Borchert (Surveyor) / Engineering consultants (Banning).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion focused on prior landowner consultation regarding three options for the A. McConnell drain. The surveyor noted existing rights-of-way from the 1970s reconstruction, allowing for potential repairs once crops are off. Discussion also addressed separating the A. McConnell watershed account from the rest of the county to prepare for future alternatives and isolate local repair costs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:08:33 Dr. Gary Hazellet** (221 West County Road 400 South) spoke against the reconstruction project, citing past unsuccessful repairs 15 years ago, potential disruption reducing agricultural land productivity, and high costs disproportionately benefiting landowners at the eastern end of the drain rather than his area.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to remove from the table and close the issue. Approved by roll call vote (**00:19:04**).
- **00:19:11 Tabled Business: Town of Selma Jurisdiction Open Ditch**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchert / Legal Counsel (Stribble).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Town of Selma approached the county regarding taking in an open ditch as a regulated drain because the town lacks funds for maintenance. Legal counsel and staff are currently working on mapping, drafting landowner letters, and gathering consents before presenting a formal proposal.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Left on the table / deferred for further review (**00:20:57**).
- **00:21:07 Tabled Business: Rector Drain Reconstruction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchert (Surveyor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The surveyor reported that the DNR confirmed no permits or mitigation are required for working on tile drains (as the Rector drain is entirely tiled with no open ditch). However, staff noted potential uncertainty regarding whether a petition signer (Mr. Cox) still supports the project after understanding the scope.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Remained on the table for another month to verify petition validity (**00:23:06**).
- **00:31:31 New Business: Bond Permit Application & Right-of-Way Reduction (Stewart Ditch / Skyler Snider Property)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchert (Surveyor) / Property Owner Skyler Snider.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Property owner Skyler Snider requested a reduction of the regulated drain right-of-way to 20 feet across a specific section to construct a retention pond in a historically wet area, along with approval to outfall the pond into Stewart Ditch. The surveyor recommended approval with appropriate stipulations to ensure access.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:35:24 Skyler Snider** (Property Owner) provided historical background on the property (former site of a reservoir dam that was removed due to liability) and assured the board that adequate access and classified forest protections remain in place.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to reduce the right-of-way to 20 feet in the requested area. Approved by roll call vote (**00:38:58**).
 - Motion to approve the requested overflow/outfall into the regulated drain. Approved by roll call vote (**00:39:24**).
- **00:40:12 Old Business: Drainage Maintenance Fund Investment (Trust Indiana)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya Dunmore (Chief Deputy Auditor) / Brad P. (County Treasurer) / Mr. Borchert.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Officials presented an investment opportunity through "Trust Indiana" (a state-level investment pool for Indiana counties yielding higher interest rates, currently around 3.6193%, compared to local bank accounts). Discussion focused on balancing liquidity to pay monthly maintenance claims against maximizing interest earnings. Staff recommended retaining approximately \$300,000 locally to cover ongoing monthly claims and buffer processing timelines, while investing the remainder.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to move \$900,000 into the Trust Indiana investment account. Approved by roll call vote (**00:47:01 / 00:57:01**).
- **00:57:16 Approval of Maintenance Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchert / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of routine monthly maintenance claims.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve maintenance claims. Approved by roll call vote (**00:57:40**).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:23:35 Skyler Southern** (613 Northwood): Addressed the board regarding severe flooding (6 inches of water) affecting three newly renovated properties following heavy rains. Inquired whether he or the county should handle local tile and drainage relief. Staff reviewed maps, noted that an 8-inch tile is flowing to the north but is impacted by local low elevations, and advised on potential private retention pond options tied into the tile.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Contractor Performance:** Discussion regarding low-bid contractors failing to perform work timely due to broken equipment. The board discussed tightening contract specifications and legal recourse.
 - **Cost of Service Study:** Brief discussion regarding an ongoing county stormwater cost of service study and its potential overlapping impacts on drainage responsibilities.
 - **Flash Flood Status:** Commissioner noted the county was placed in a yellow status due to flash flooding, mentioning specific road closures and drainage concerns near Progress Rail.
 - **Next Meeting Rescheduling:** Due to county council budget hearings occupying the meeting room in September, the board voted to reschedule the next meeting to **Tuesday, September 8 at 2:00 P.M.** Approved by roll call vote (00:16:19).
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by motion (00:17:20).

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